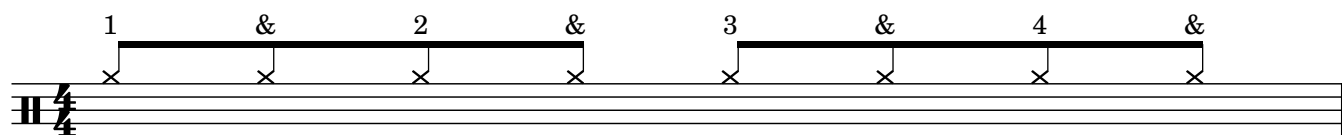


Three Rock Beats

Traditional, Arr. Jacobo-Vega-Albela

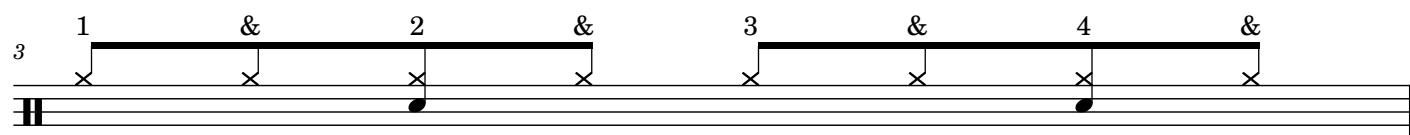
Most styles of drum groove have a traditional *ostinato*. An ostinato is a repeating musical pattern. Our rock ostinato has two parts, and we will start with the hi hat:



Next, the snare:



And now the two combined. This is a very common traditional ostinato in rock music, and we will see this pattern over and over through our exploration of the style.



The bass drum will be our variable in this worksheet. In our first example the kick plays on every other beat, like so:

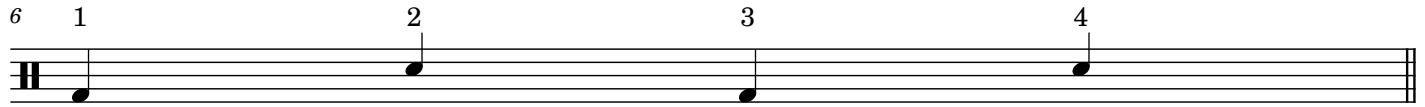


The hi hat and bass drum together:

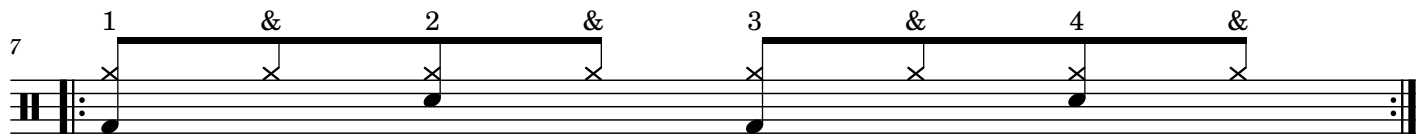


2

And now the bass and snare together. In this style of music, the bass and snare have a melodic relationship. If we can learn to hear their parts together as a simple two-note tune, memorization of grooves becomes much easier.

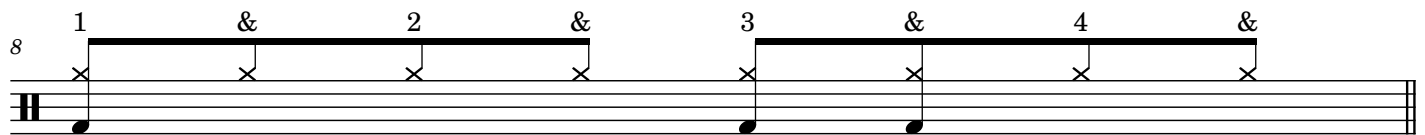


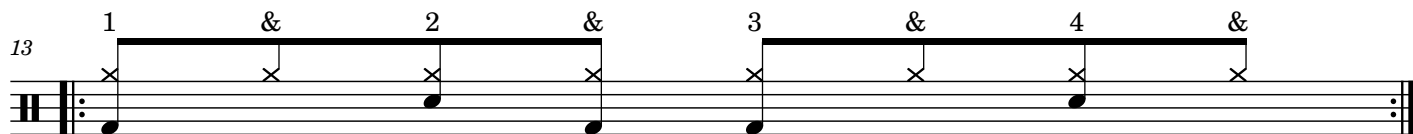
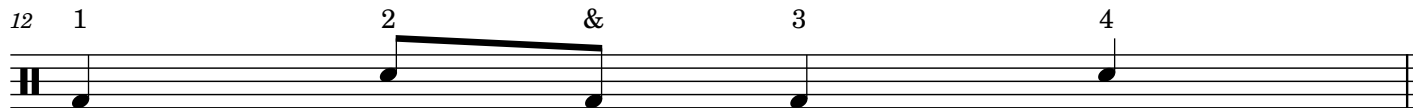
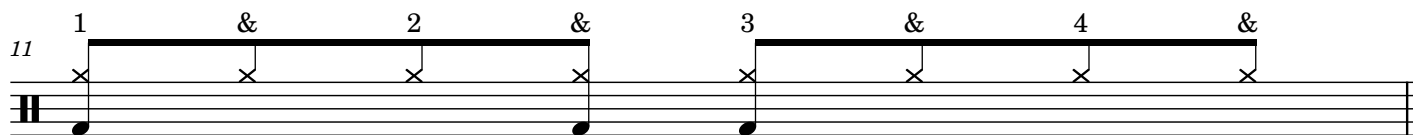
Finally, the complete pattern. Notice the repeat signs. Practice making a loop out of this, and get comfortable playing it over and over again. This, like many other rock beats is a *three-voice pattern*; three of our limbs work together to play the part. Breaking down any three-voice pattern into its constituent two-voice combinations works wonders towards making complex ideas feel simple and digestible.



All the following patterns use the same *ostinato* in the hands. Only combinations of hi hat + bass drum, and bass drum + snare will be shown as we build up the complete patterns. Here we start with hi hat and bass drum for our first variation:

Variation A



Variation B**Variation A: Continuous**

4

Variation B: Continuous



20

